

XIANGYU MA

Nanyang Technological University
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Employment

Assistant Professor of Sociology, Nanyang Technological University

2023 to present.

Education

Ph.D. Sociology, University of Chicago, 2023.

Dissertation: "Moral matters in cultural spaces."

Advisors: John Levi Martin (chair), Amanda Sharkey, & James Evans.

M.A. Sociology, University of Chicago, 2018.

B.A. Sociology, Pomona College, 2017. Magna Cum Laude.

Publications

Journal Articles

Ma, Xiangyu. 2026. "On the deep, surprising, and persistently gendered dynamics in complex music tastes." *Socius*.

Ma, Xiangyu. 2024. "Tastes and complex tastes." *Cultural Sociology*.

Ma, Xiangyu. 2024. "The costliest signals of authenticity? How iconic deaths transform audience reception in hip-hop." *Poetics*.

Ma, Xiangyu. 2021. "What are the temporal dynamics of taste?" *Poetics*.

- Best student paper award from the ASA Consumption and Consumers Section, 2022.

Book Chapters

Lembo, Alessandra, **Xiangyu Ma** & John Levi Martin. 2023. "New directions in the sociology of morality." *Handbook of the Sociology of Morality*.

In-Progress

Ma, Xiangyu, Mengmi Zhang, Shannon Ang, & Minne Chen. In preparation. "Not-quite-human tastes: the stylized omnivorousness of LLM survey surrogates." Available on *ArXiv* at <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.30085>.

Ma, Xiangyu & Hongyu Jiang. Under review. "The temporal dynamics behind tastes for flowers."

Lam Hock Yuen Nickolas, Voo Ji Xuan, and **Ma, Xiangyu**. In preparation. "The flawed and conditional superiority of fast silicon sampling." Available on *ArXiv* at <https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.14079>.

Ma, Xiangyu. In preparation. "Twitter and the politicization of mediated scandals in weakly autonomous cultural fields."

Conference Presentations & Talks

"On the deep, surprising, and durably gendered dynamics in complex music tastes." Presented at the 2026 Pacific Sociological Association Meeting.

"The gendered habitus: on the surprising gendered homologies in taste structures." Presented at the 2025 International Conference on Social Science Methodology. University of Naples.

"The gendered habitus: on the surprising gendered homologies in taste structures." Presented at the 2025 International Conference on Survey Methodology, Application, and New Developments. Academia Sinica.

"The costliest signals of authenticity? How death inflates artistic reputations in hip-hop." 2023. Presented at the 2023 Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association.

"What is taste?" 2023. Presented at the International Sociological Association's World Congress of Sociology 2023.

"What is taste?" 2023. Presented at the Eastern Sociological Society Meeting 2023.

"Tastes and complex tastes." 2022. Sociology of Culture Workshop. University of California, Santa Barbara.

"Tastes, complex tastes & meta-tastes." 2022. Presented at the 2022 Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, panel session on *International Perspectives on Cultural Sociology*.

"Denunciations and scandals in a cultural market." 2022. Stigler Center Lunch Workshop. University of Chicago.

"What are the temporal dynamics of taste?" 2021. Center for Cultural Affairs, Indiana University Bloomington.

"Cultural consumption as voluntaristic action." 2021. Presented at the 2021 Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, panel session on *Consumers, Consumption, and Well-being*.

Fellowships, Awards & Grants

Co-PI on Social Science & Humanities Research (SSHR) Seed Grant 2025 (\$\$30,000)

PI on Social Science & Humanities Research (SSHR) Seed Grant 2024 (\$\$30,000)

PI on Ministry of Education Tier 1 Seed Grant (\$\$50,000)

PI on Nanyang Technological University Start-Up Grant (\$\$35,000)

International Sociology Association World Congress of Sociology Grant

Michael and Ling Markovitz Dissertation Completion Fellowship, University of Chicago.

Henderson research grant (US\$3,000), University of Chicago

Stigler Center PhD Dissertation Award and Bradley Fellow (US\$5,000), University of Chicago (Booth)

Wing C. Chan and Angelina H. Li Fund research grant (US\$1,500), University of Chicago

College of Humanities, Arts, and Social Sciences (HASS) International PhD Scholarship, Nanyang Technological University.

Ministry of Education-Autonomous University (MOE-AU) Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Singapore.

Independent Summer Undergraduate Research Program Award, Pomona College.

Edward J. Sexton Fellow, Claremont McKenna College.

Robert Day Scholar, Claremont McKenna College.

Arthur R. Adams Fellow, Claremont McKenna College.

Kravis Prize Fellowship, Claremont McKenna College.

Teaching

As Instructor

"Computational Social Science."	2025–2025
"Introduction to Computational Social Science."	2025–2026
"Contemporary Social Theory (undergraduate)."	2024–2025
"Contemporary Social Theory (graduate)."	2024–2025
"Research Practicum on Quantitative Social Research."	2023–2024

As Teaching Assistant

"Advanced Statistical Methods in the Social Sciences."	Spring 2020
"Introduction to Spatial Data Science."	Fall 2019

“Introduction to Statistical Methods in the Social Sciences.”

Winter 2019

“Introduction to Statistical Methods in the Social Sciences.”

Winter 2018

Mentorship

I have advised undergraduate students on both qualitative and quantitative research projects for their final year theses, winning grants such as the Jek Yuen Thong Community Development Fund Grant.

Professional Service

CoHASS College-Wide Standing Search Committee at Nanyang Technological University, 2025-present

Undergraduate admissions coordinator at Nanyang Technological University, 2025-present

Editorial board at *Sage Open*, 2025-2026.

Program committee for Population Association of Singapore 2025 Annual Meeting.

Occasional reviewer for *American Journal of Sociology*, *American Sociological Review*, *Cultural Sociology*, *Frontiers in Cognition*, *International Journal of Anthropology and Ethnology*, *Poetics*, *Socio-Economic Review*.

Program committee for International Conference on Computational Social Science 2024.

Sociology management committee at Nanyang Technological University, 2024-.

Graduate admissions committee at Nanyang Technological University, 2023-2025.

Seminar series committee at Nanyang Technological University, 2023-

Graduate editorial intern at the Socio-Economic Review, 2022-2023.

Manuscript review board at the American Journal of Sociology, 2021-2022.

Technical Skills

Languages: English (native), Mandarin (native), Python (fluent), R (fluent), Japanese (basic), Stata (basic).